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CD grapevine

BY RICK CAMPBELL
SCRIPPS HOWARD NEWS SERVICE

'J.Lo' is an album full of pop promise

• J.LO, Jennifer Lopez (Epic)

Jennifer Lopez made her singing debut with "On the 6" in the summer of 1999, a shameless bid to cash in on the Latin pop "explosion" initiated by Ricky Martin.

Turns out "On the 6" was the most enduring release of the bunch, nailing hits and multiplatinum sales.

Lopez's new "J.Lo" is even more impressive. She flits across a spectrum of pop genres, easily assimilating the nuances of each cut, including the twangy hip-hop assertions of the first single "Love Don't Cost a Thing," the Latin horns on "Dame (Touch Me)," the soft techno of "Play" (an answer to Madonna's "Music," perhaps?) and the classic pop of "I'm Real." She's a more than adequate singer who adapts to whatever role each song demands – devoted lover on Santana knockoff "Caringo," unflappable optimist on "Ain't It Funny", obsessive sexpot on "Secretly", confident suitor on the urban track "That's the Way".

Lopez's producer-boyfriend Sean "Puffy" Combs is around for the cause, though his work is a detriment to the tortured "That's Not Me" and the rote "Dance With Me." Plus there's a schizophrenic feeling from the army of songwriters: It's amazing that it took nine people to pen something as ordinary as "I'm Gonna Be Alright."

Although several of the tracks aren't worth a second listen and the album is inconsequential as a whole, "J.Lo" is a crafty bit of pop.

Rating (five possible): 3.7.

• O-TOWN, O-Town (J Records)

If a young woman in your life has developed an affinity for O-Town, it's time for an intervention.

It was one thing to overlook love of 'N Sync and Backstreet Boys – groups with at least some skill and charisma – but O-Town brings nothing to the boy-band genre.

"O-Town" crosses the line from glossy, superficial pop music to stupefying, pre-fab bubblegum. Unlike catchy refrains that seduce their way into the subconscious, the hooks on "O-Town" bully their way in with mental warfare, hammering at the brain with awful repetitions that linger like the stench of roadkill.

For those who missed the tacky ABC reality show "Making the Band," the members of O-Town were assembled as a group on that program. They fought, whined, showed very little talent.

Now Ashley, Dan, Erik, Jacob and Trevor deliver their inevitably bad self-titled debut.

And unfortunately, it isn't likely to be their swan song: First single "Liquid Dreams," systematically lame and representative of the rest of the album, pushed the limits of bad taste to the Top 10, providing a degrading checklist of female celebrities set to cheesy synthesizer.

There are no leaders in O-Town, no sense of control. These are guys who struggle amongst themselves not to be the weakest of the weak.

Compounding the trauma, the sadistic material sets up the poor lads to make spectacles of themselves, parading them through embarrassing cliches and turning "O-Town" into a pseudo-parody.

The ineffective "Beatles-esque" song "Love Should Be a Crime" is particularly clumsy and uproarious. Sadly, it's also the best song.

Rating: 1

• YORK BLVD., Acetone (Vapor)

The Los Angeles-based trio Acetone goes for atmosphere above all else.

Listless, self-conscious atmosphere that may have worked for Velvet Underground or even Mazzy Star, but only because those acts had more going on than a drone.

Acetone's Richie Lee (bass), Mark Lightcap (guitar) and Steve Hadley (drums) shuffle along "York Blvd." in zombie-like fashion, too lazy or bored to stray far from the monotonous haze generated by ad nauseum refrains, barely there vocals and blurry guitar. What personality the group demonstrated on past releases has leeched away.

This one-gimmick album is lulling in small doses, before the feebleness of Lee's vocals sinks in and the pointlessness of it all hits home. "Things Are Gonna Be Alright," "Wonderful World," "Like I Told You" and "One Drop" may weave listeners into a trance, with their unhurried subtleties and retro vibe, yet prolonged and/or repeated exposure is purely unnerving.

No one has this much time to kill.

Rating: 2

– Chuck Campbell is the entertainment editor at the News-Sentinel in Knoxville, Tenn.

TV TONIGHT

WEDNESDAY PRIME TIME

STATION	1	T1	T2	T3	T4	GL	7:00	7:30	8:00	8:30	9:00	9:30	10:00	10:30	11:00	11:30
WKNT (FOX)	7	14	-	15	-	15	College Basketball: Tennessee at Arkansas (Live)				The Show	Grounded ...	Temptation Island (n)		Roseanne (n)	GraceFire
WSMV (NBC)	8	9	4	4	9	4	Kid: The Music Box (n)		The West Wing (n)		Law & Order (n)		News		Tonight Show With Jay Leno	Late Night
WBKO (ABC)	9	11	2	13	11	13	Who Wants to Be a Millionaire		Drew Carey	Spin City (n)	Once and Again (n)		News		Nightline (n)	Politically ...
WTVF (CBS)	10	5	5	5	5	5	Belle (n)	Welcome to NY	Jewel (TV) (Fergie Fawcett, Casey Tyson) (n)				News		Late Show W/David Letterman	ET
WKYU (PBS)	11	10	6	12	13	6	The NewsHour With Jim Lehrer		Soul of Africa (n)		Main Street	Legends of Air	Charlie Rose (n)			Off the Air
WBWG (WB)	12	-	-	-	-	-	Dawson's Creek (n)		Jack & Jill (n)		Jamie Foxx	Wayans Bros.	Wayans Bros.	Jamie Foxx	Roseanne (n)	
FX	21	-	-	-	-	-	M*A*S*H (n)	M*A*S*H (n)	Married ...	Married ...	Shocking Behavior on Tape 2		The X Show		In Living Color	The X-Files (Part 2 of 2) (n)
WCDI (PBS)	22	-	8	8	6	-	World of National Geographic		Championship Ballroom Dancing			Crown Country	Business Rpt.	Riding Sidesaddle	Daily Mass: Our Lady of Angels	
WKGB (KET)	26	12	9	9	12	8	World of National Geographic		Championship Ballroom Dancing			Crown Country	Gen. Assembly	People Count	Off the Air	
WZTV (FOX)	27	7	7	11	7	10	The Show	Grounded ...	Temptation Island (n)		News		Spin City (n)	3rd Rock	Spin City (n)	Sud. Susan
WUXP (UPN)	30	-	11	2	10	-	College Basketball: Tennessee at Arkansas (Live)				Jamie Foxx	The Simpsons	Andy Griffith	Andy Griffith	Star Trek: Voyager (n)	
AMC	34	29	-	27	29	37	Angel and the Badman (TV) ★★★ (John Wayne, Gail Russell)				The Conversation (R), TV, ★★★★ (Gene Hackman) (n)				The King of Comedy (R)	
A&E	39	41	-	36	31	45	Biography (n)		American Justice (n)		Investigative Reports (n)		Law & Order (n)		Biography (n)	
USA	40	30	33	35	30	24	Noah Bridges: Knockout (n)		The Terminator (R, '84) ★★★ (Arnold Schwarzenegger) (n)				Martin (n)	Martin (n)	Strip Poker	Femme Nikita
NICK	42	-	25	45	32	25	Thornberrys	Brady Bunch	Facts of Life	Facts of Life	It's Company	It's Company	All in Family	The Jeffersons	I Love Lucy	Facts of Life
TNN	43	35	29	44	35	32	Martial Law: Red Storm (n)		Movie				The Magnificent Seven (n)		Miami Vice (n)	
CNN	44	38	24	37	38	27	Bitter Rivals	The Point	Larry King Live (n)		CNN Tonight	The Spin Room	Sports Tonight	Moneyline	Larry King Live	
COM	60	-	-	-	-	-	Chasin & Chong's Next Movie (R, '98) ★ (Cheech Marin)				South Park (n)	TV Funhouse	Daily Show	Stein's Money	The Man Show	South Park (n)
ESPN	45	24	35	41	24	26	College Basketball: (n) (Live) (n)		College Basketball: Duke at Clemson (Live) (n)				SportsCenter (n)		Hoops Tonight	NBA 2Night
ESPN2	15	25	-	42	25	-	NHL Hockey: (n) (n) Philadelphia Flyers at Pittsburgh Penguins (Live) (n)						NHL Hockey: Chicago Blackhawks at Anaheim Mighty Ducks (Live) (n)			
FSS	56	-	-	-	-	-	Sports Tonight	Countdown	Boxing: Steve Forbes vs. David Santos, Junior Lightweights				National Sports Report		Region. Sports	The Last Word
HGTV	55	27	-	49	27	-	Appraise It!	Appraised Fair	Treasure Maker	Small Space	Dream Home 2001		Appraise It!	Appraised Fair	Treasure Maker	Small Space
LIFE	46	39	37	39	39	39	Unsolved Mysteries		Don't Talk to Strangers (R, '94) ★★ (Donna Mills) (n)				Golden Girls	Golden Girls	Designing	Designing
LEARN	47	-	-	31	-	18	Monster Machines		Monster Machines: Minors		Building the Biggest Sky Giant		Monster Machines		Monster Machines: Minors	
FAMILY	49	26	-	47	26	23	Rocket's Red Glare (10) ★★ (Robert Wagner) (n)				Early Edition (n)		The 700 Club (n)		Who's Boss?	Who's Boss?
BET	50	-	21	34	-	40	Oh Drama!	Amen	ComicView		BET Live		BET News	BET Tonight	Midnight Love	
E!	51	-	-	-	-	-	Wyatt./Scandals	Wyatt./Scandals	The E! True Hollywood Story		Celebrity Profile (n)		Howard Stern	Howard Stern	Wild On ... Adventure (n)	
WTBS	17	16	14	7	41	9	Ripley's Believe It or Not! (n)		WCW Thunder (n)				Ripley's Believe It or Not! (n)		WCW Thunder (n)	
WGN	18	15	15	16	16	3	Paradise (PG-13, '91) ★★ (Melanie Griffith, Don Johnson) (n)				News (n)		MacGyver: Fire and Ice (n)		Matlock (Part 2 of 2) (n)	
TNT	19	33	31	26	33	34	NBA Basketball: Sacramento Kings at Minnesota Timberwolves (Live) (n)					Inside the NBA	Hoop Dreams (PG-13, '94) ★★★ (n)			
TDC	20	23	32	25	23	35	Mysteries of the Pyramids (n)		Ancient Earthquakes		Deadline Discovery		Justice Files: Doing Time			Mysteries of the Pyramids (n)
TCM	115	28	-	46	28	-	It's Wars Free (30) ★ (Irene Dunne, Clive Brook)				On Borrowed Time (39) ★★★ (Lionel Barrymore) (n)				Small Town Girl (36) ★★★ (Janet Gaynor)	
SCI-FI	111	-	-	32	-	16	Space: Above and Beyond (n)		Asteroid (Part 1) (TV) ★ (Michael Biehn, Annabella Sciorra) (n)				John Edward	John Edward	Quantum Leap (n)	
FOX MOVIE	59	-	-	-	-	-	Modern Problems (PG, '81) ★ (Chevy Chase, Patti D'Arbanville)				The Park Is Mine (R) ★ (Tommy Lee Jones, Helen Shaver)				Raid on Entebbe (TV) ★★★ (n)	
CARTOON	61	40	-	30	40	50	Cow & Chicken	Laboratory	Bugs & Daffy	Tom & Jerry	Flintstones (n)	Scooby Doo	Cow & Chicken	Laboratory	Dragon Ball Z	Outlaw Star
HISTORY	63	31	-	-	-	-	History's Mysteries (n)		War of the Century (n)		Celebrity Profile (n)		The Big House (n)		History's Mysteries (n)	

PREMIUM CHANNELS

HBO	14	3	17	22	3	26	Anna and the King (n) (PG-13, '99) ★★ (Jodie Foster) (n)				Dr. The Blizzard of '01 (n)		The Corner (n)		The Corner (11:10) (n)	
HBO2	66	-	-	21	-	-	Enthusiasm	Larry Sanders	Pushing To (R, '98) ★★ (John Cusack, Billy Bob Thornton) (n)				Story of the 1980 U.S. Hockey Team		Colors (n)	
HBO3	67	-	-	-	-	-	The Red Violin (2:40) (R) (n)		Jagged Edge (R, '85) ★★★ (Glenn Close, Jeff Bridges)				Gloria (R, '98) ★★ (Sharon Stone, Jean-Luke Figueroa) (n)			
SHOWTIME	72	19	20	17	19	22	Scorpion (TV) (Bill Pullman) becomes an actor and dinner! (n)				Soul Food (n)		Resurrection Blvd. (n)		Lethal Weapon (R, '87) ★★★ (n)	
SHOWTIME2	73	20	-	18	20	-	Wayans in Seattle (n) (PG) (n)		Soul Food (n)		The Portrait of a Lady (PG-13, '96) ★★ (Nicole Kidman, John Malkovich) (n)					Risky Business
STARZ	71	22	-	-	22	-	Boys on the Side (R, '95) ★★★ (Whoopi Goldberg) (n)				Coming Soon (R, '99) ★★★ (Tricia Vessey, Gaby Hoffman) (n)				American Pie (10:45) (R) (n)	
DISNEY	15	34	23	28	34	17	Movie (n)	The Duke (G, '99) ★★ (John Neville)			Squanto: A Warrior's Tale (8:10) (PG, '94) ★★★ (n)				Zorro (n)	M. Mouse Club
TMC	74	6	18	19	6	42	FXS (5:15)		Hitchcock: Bloodline (R, '96) ★ (n)			Bit of Echoes (3:25) (R, '99) ★★★ (n)			Bring Me the Head of ... (11:05)	
CINEMAX	68	-	19	20	-	41	Movie (5:30)	The 4th Floor (R, '99) ★★ (Aria Lange) (n)			Girl, Interrupted (R, '99) ★★ (Winona Ryder, Angelina Jolie) (n)				Passion Cove (11:15) (n)	

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Black History Month featured online

By Dave Peyton
Tribune Media Services

Carter G. Woodson would be amazed.

Negro History Week, which he founded in 1926, is now Black History Month. And black history has spread via the World Wide Web.

For anyone with access to the Web, there's no excuse for not knowing the contributions African-Americans have made to our world.

The best site is the Encyclopedia Britannica Guide to Black History (http://blackhistory.eb.com), which covers five centuries of black history. It begins in the 16th century with the earliest slave revolts in the New World and takes us up to the present.

A timeline that traces the contributions of African-Americans in politics, industry, the arts, religion, sports and education. This site offers articles, film clips, recordings, photographs and other images.

Infoplease.com has a page for Black History Month at http://www.infoplease.com/spot/bhm1.html. This site includes articles about Negro League baseball, African-American literature and black scientists and inventors.

Exploring your family history is a special Black History Month feature of the Learning Network's Family Education division. To get to the site, go to http://www.familyeducation.com, then click on the "Celebrate Black History" headline in the middle of the page. This site aids parents who are helping their children search for family roots.

Black Facts Online is a search page at http://www.blackfacts.com that lets you look up Black History information by date or keywords.

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WHAT WOMEN WANT (PG-13) (STS) 7:30-9:45
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SNATCH (R) 7:15-9:15
SAVE THE LAST DANCE (PG-13) 7:15-9:30
SUGAR & SPICE (PG-13) 7:30-9:30
VALENTINE (R) 7:30-9:45
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